

Red Maple

Acer rubrum



Origin

Native to nearly the entire eastern half of North America, from Newfoundland to Florida -- one of the most widely distributed trees on the continent.

Look for

True to its name, red maple shows red in nearly every season: red flowers in earliest spring, reddish leaf stalks in summer, red fall color, and red twigs in winter.

IDENTIFICATION TIPS

- Leaf: three-to-five-lobed leaf, smaller and less deeply cut than Norway maple's.
- Color: reddish in nearly every season -- flowers, leaf stalks, fall color, and winter twigs.
- Seed: paired winged samaras that spin like helicopters, among the fastest-germinating tree seeds.
- Commonly confused with: silver maple (red maple's leaf lobes are shallower and its underside is greener, not silvery-white).

THROUGH THE SEASONS

Spring	Small red flowers bloom very early, often before other trees wake up.
Summer	Three-to-five-lobed green leaves.
Fall	Often the first tree on the block to turn -- brilliant scarlet, orange, or yellow.
Winter	Reddish twigs and buds are visible even in the coldest months.

DID YOU KNOW

- Its paired winged seeds (samaras) spin like tiny helicopters and are one of the fastest-germinating tree seeds -- some sprout within days of falling.
- Because it tolerates both wet and dry soils better than most maples, it's one of the most adaptable native trees planted in cities.